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Innspark Asset Management & IT Policy (INNIT-PLY-20256001)

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1 Purpose

This policy protects the **confidentiality, integrity, and availability** of Company information systems and data while enabling employees to perform their duties efficiently. It defines how Company-owned or Company-managed IT resources may be accessed, used, stored, transferred, or disposed of, and clarifies every employee's responsibilities in safeguarding those resources.

2 Scope

This policy applies to

Category	In scope
People	All permanent and temporary employees, contractors, interns, consultants, and volunteers who are granted access to Company IT resources (“users”).
Assets	Desktops, laptops, mobile devices, servers, networking equipment, peripherals, removable media, cloud services, business applications, and any data created or stored on those systems.
Locations	Every Company office, branch, client site, home-office, or public venue where Company devices or data are used.

3 Definitions

Term	Definition
IT Mail	Central mailbox for IT requests, incident reports, and change approvals. (See § 14 Contacts.)
Company IT Asset	Any hardware, software, licence, or cloud subscription provided by the Company.
Data Classifications	*Public* (no restriction) · *Internal* (staff only) · **Confidential** (need-to-know; **encrypt in transit & at rest**) · **Restricted** (highest sensitivity—regulatory / personal / financial).
Asset Out-Pass	Signed authorisation allowing an IT asset to leave a Company site temporarily.
MDM	Mobile Device Management enforcing PIN, encryption, and remote-wipe on mobile devices.

4 Roles & Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
IT Department	Enforce policy; provision and monitor systems; maintain logs; conduct investigations; issue Asset Out-Passes and IT-NOC certificates.
Employees / Users	**Comply with all requirements**, safeguard devices and data, report incidents, complete training, and return assets on departure.
Reporting Managers	Approve or reject user requests requiring managerial endorsement (firewall exceptions, out-passes, exceptions).
Manager - IT	Grant time-bound policy exceptions, adjudicate appeals on damage assessments, approve annual policy reviews.

5 Policy Statements

5.1 Identity & Access Controls

1. **Strong Credentials & MFA — MANDATORY.** Users must create passwords meeting Company complexity standards (8+ characters with a mix of Alphabets, numbers and special characters) and enable multi-factor authentication (MFA) wherever available.
2. **Account Ownership.** Credential sharing is prohibited without approval. Accounts are disabled on exit or role change.

3. **Password Reuse / Storage.** Company passwords may **not** be reused on external sites and must be stored only in the Company-approved vault (never on any personal manager).
4. **Workstation Locking.** Users must lock their computers whenever leaving their workstation.

5.2 Device Security & Data Protection

1. **Mandatory Security Stack — DO NOT DISABLE.** Antivirus/EDR, agents, host firewall, full-disk encryption, and auto-patching installed by IT must remain active.
2. **Data-Classification Handling**
   • *Public* – unrestricted
   • *Internal* – share only within the Company
   • **Confidential / Restricted** – **encrypt in transit & at rest**; distribute strictly on a need-to-know basis
3. **Authorised Storage Locations.** Company data (all classifications) must reside only on IT approved platforms. Personal cloud drives, unencrypted USBs, or external disks require IT **approval**. **All data on Company assets is Company property.**
4. **Peripheral & Media Controls.** No personal peripherals, components, stickers, or modifications—including unauthorised USB/Bluetooth devices—may be attached without IT approval.
5. **Clean Desk / Clear Screen.** Secure physical documents and credentials; no sticky-note passwords; clear screens when unattended.
6. **Secure Printing & Disposal.** Retrieve printouts immediately; shred Confidential/Restricted paper when no longer needed. Printing Company documents through outside vendors requires prior approval.
7. **Photography & Filming.** Capturing images or video of confidential screens, server rooms, or workspaces is prohibited unless prior written permission is obtained.
8. **Intellectual-Property & Confidentiality.** All work product, source code, documents, and know-how created on Company time or equipment belong to the Company and must not be shared externally without NDA or legal clearance.
9. **Approved Operating Systems Only.** Operating systems on Company assets should not be changed unless it is approved by the IT & infrastructure team. No additional components other than approved are to be installed in company assets.
   Exceptions are permitted **solely based on following for OS testing purposes**:
   • be approved by the team lead, and
   • include an e-mail to **IT Mail** detailing the OS name, edition, and version.
10. **External Network.** No external network, other than company provided network may be used on the company assets. Exceptions provided for on-field employees, but the asset should not connect back to developer or server networks without approval and following the instructions.

5.3 Acceptable Use of E-mail, Web & Applications

1. **Business Purpose.** Company e-mail, messaging, and collaboration tools are for legitimate business activities only; **assets must not be used for personal activities of any kind**. Auto-forwarding to personal addresses is prohibited.
2. **Phishing Defence — CRITICAL.** Report suspected phishing immediately to **IT Mail**; do **not** open links or attachments.
3. **Web-Browsing Restrictions — ABSOLUTE. Employees must refrain from accessing any website, online service, downloaded content, install applications or not required for**

assigned job duties, in company assets. Temporary exceptions demand a written business justification **and** dual approval from IT **and** the Reporting Manager.

4. Anti-Harassment & Acceptable Content (discriminatory or obscene material banned).
5. Social Media – posting Company data or branding requires Communications approval.
6. Prohibited Computing Activities – no crypto-mining, password-cracking, P2P, bulk spam, or high-CPU/network tasks without IT authorisation.
7. **Licensed-Software & Copyright Compliance – install only IT-supplied or properly licensed software; pirated or cracked content is forbidden.**
8. **Firewall / Access-Control Changes.** Institute firewalls are enforced by default; any rule change requires an e-mail to **IT Mail** with business justification and written approval from the Reporting Manager.
9. Network Stress Tests – scanning, penetration testing, or bulk crawling requires a scheduled IT change ticket and prior written approval.
10. Shadow-IT Ban – spinning up any new SaaS/cloud tool (even free-tier) requires prior IT approval; data must not be uploaded to unapproved services.
11. **No Official Content to Public AI.** Staff **must not** paste or upload any Company-owned content—including documents, excerpts, source code, data samples, or prompts containing sensitive information—into publicly hosted AI/Large-Language-Model services (e.g., ChatGPT, Gemini, Copilot, Bard). Work-related generative-AI tasks may be carried out **only on locally hosted or IT-approved private AI platforms**.

5.4 Physical Asset Handling

1. **On-Site Control.** Company IT assets shall not leave Company premises without IT approval.
2. **No External Hand-Offs.** Assets must **never** be given to non-Company individuals.
3. **Internal Transfers.** Devices may not be passed to colleagues until officially logged and approved; original custodians remain fully responsible (cleanliness, care, security) until IT confirms hand-over.
4. **Condition & Cleanliness.** Keep devices clean; neglect causing hygienic or functional degradation may incur cleaning fees or be deemed damage.
5. **Physical Security in Transit.** Carry-on luggage only; never leave devices in unattended vehicles; use cable locks or locked drawers in shared spaces.
6. **Loss, Theft or Physical Damages — REPORT WITHIN 1 HOUR.**
   a. File a police report (FIR) immediately and e-mail a copy to **IT Mail:** in case of Loss, Theft or Physical Damage caused by another person intentionally.
   b. Submit an Incident Report to **IT Mail** within one hour.
   c. A Damage-Assessment Panel determines liability ,if caused due to carelessness of the Employee; **charges may equal the cost of a new replacement plus labour, data-recovery expenses, and related business loss.** Employees may appeal once.
7. **Return on Separation.** All hardware, access cards, and licences must be surrendered by the last working day. HR clearance is withheld until IT & infrastructure Team issues a **No-Dues certificate (IT-NOC)**.

5.5 Network & Remote-Work Security

1. **VPN — MANDATORY.** All off-site access to the internal portals must traverse the Company VPN.
2. **Public Wi-Fi Rule.** Do not use public/hotel Wi-Fi, which are not secured via WPA2 or above.

3. **BYOD Controls.** Personal devices accessing Company resources must enrol in MDM, enable PIN/biometrics, encryption, and enable remote wipe by the employee in case of device loss.
4. **Patch & OS Currency (BYOD).** Personal devices must run vendor-supported OS versions and install security patches **within 7 days** of release.
5. **End-of-Life for BYOD.** Before selling, recycling, or disposing of a personal device that stored Company data, users must perform an IT-verified secure wipe.
6. **Data Caching.** Local caches of Company data stay encrypted and auto-purge after the IT-defined retention period.

5.6 Server & infrastructure Controls

1. **VM Provisioning.** Only IT & infrastructure team may create or approve additional virtual machines on Company physical servers; requests must be logged via an IT ticket.
2. **Test-Server Access.** Temporary test access must use time-bound accounts and be monitored by IT.
3. **Production-Server Builds.** Before any production machine is brought online in Company DC, the owning team must submit an up-to-date architecture diagram and platform description for IT approval.
4. **Production-Server Changes.** Any architecture changes in the production servers managed by other departments within the company should be notified to the IT & infrastructure Team via email.
5. **Production-Server Access.** sudo/administrator user access & management access to be provided to the IT & infrastructure team, for all the Physical servers managed by the non-IT & infrastructure team. The credentials set for the sudo user / administrator accounts & the Management portal should not be changed without informing the IT & infrastructure Team via Email.
6. **VDI-First Rule.** All software-development and data-engineering work must be performed inside the Company-provided **Virtual Desktop infrastructure (VDI)**. If a VDI session is impossible for technical reasons, developers may request time-bound access to a **single, isolated physical machine** without the internet. Such requests must be raised via IT & infrastructure Mail and include justification, duration, and the isolation method to be used.

5.7 Logging & Monitoring

1. **Activity Logging.** E-mail, web, and endpoint events are logged for security, operational, and legal purposes and retained per the Records Schedule.

5.8 Incident Reporting & Response

1. **One-Hour Rule — NON-NEGOTIABLE.** Users must report any suspected breach, policy violation, or equipment/data loss to **IT Mail** within one hour. If e-mail is unavailable, call the IT Service Desk.
2. **Evidence Preservation.** Do not power-cycle devices, alter files, or disconnect media unless directed by IT.
3. **Reporting Security Weaknesses.** Report vulnerabilities to **IT Mail** immediately. **Good-faith reporters will not be penalised.**

5.9 Awareness

1. **Onboarding Acknowledgement.** New hires must read and sign this policy before receiving any IT asset or account.
2. **Employee Acknowledgement.** All employees must read this policy fully.

6 Compliance, Enforcement & Exceptions

1. **Disciplinary Actions.** Breaches trigger progressive discipline actions. Monetary recovery pursued for Company losses.
2. **Exception Process.** Requests for deviation must be e-mailed to **IT Mail** with business justification and risk assessment; IT approval is required, time-bound, and logged.
3. **Annual Review.** This policy is reviewed if legal, technological, or business changes arise.

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7 Document Control

Version	Date	Author	Summary of Changes
1.0	**03-Jun-2025**	IT & infrastructure Department	Initial release

8 Contacts

Purpose	Contact
IT & infrastructure E-mail (“IT Mail”)	**cisai-itsupport@am.amrita.edu**
IT & infrastructure Service Desk (Emergency)	+91 476 280 5489 Branch specific phone numbers will be provided.

For IT **For HR** **Director**

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